

money but if you are comfortable working on it then you should go for it. However, installing modules on IIS is a time consuming issue.

From a survey we found that IIS web servers are maximum utilised in Fortune 500 companies and the Apache server is utilised maximum in popular internet web sites.

IIS is prone to getting infected with bugs. In a 2009 incident of hacking, Netcraft claimed that the hacked Virginia site was running IIS 5.0 and 6.0 on Windows 2000 and 2003. IIS always had security problems. This is the ideal prey for hackers. Linux, on the other hand, hasn't experienced attacks from worms or viruses.

Performance wise, both of them meet minimum requirements in terms of speed, stability, and scalability. Speed wise, when it comes to static documents, IIS is faster and Apache lags behind. This is mainly due to lack of multi-threading and scalability problems with Linux. Multi-threading refers to multiple processes or threads running together simultaneously. Scalability refers to addition of modules to the system without affecting the system.

Although the performance of Apache on Linux is considered to be one of the best, it also has some scalability issues. Both Apache and IIS are stable, if properly configured. Problems may occur due to system failure. In this case, Apache has an advantage, because all Windows applications (IIS) are kernel extensions. This means, the faulty application might kill the whole system as kernel is the heart of a system. Linux applications are isolated from kernel. This way, even if an application fails, it is very unlikely that it will have any effect on the kernel.

Ultimately what matters is what you are comfortable with. If you're familiar with IIS and investing isn't a matter of concern for your client, then use .NET. On the other hand, if you're more comfortable with Linux and budget is critical, then opt for LAMP.

3.2 Choosing a CMS for the chosen platform

A Content Management System is used to manage the content of a web page. It gives even a novice a chance to build a web site. It is a web application that uses database (usually MySQL) to create, store and edit HTML content in a manageable way. A CMS stores your content in a database. In case you're not familiar with it, here's a brief description.

CMS consists of two elements: Content Management application (CMA) and Content Delivery Application (CDA). CMA allows the content manager to manage the creation, modification, and removal of content from a web site without needing the expertise of a web master. Content manager does not require having any programming skills or knowing HTML to achieve the same. Content Delivery Application uses and